

Or Face Jail

4th Official In Bail Fund Told to Talk

NEW YORK, July 23 (AP).—Once more the Government used a contempt threat today to try to pry loose bail records of the Civil Rights Congress.

This time, the action was directed against Abner Green, a bail fund trustee who thus far has escaped imprisonment. Three of his associates are serving contempt sentences.

Green was ordered by Federal Judge John F. X. McGohey to produce books and records Wednesday for a Federal grand jury.

At the same time, the threat of contempt hung over three other Civil Rights Congress attaches, who were scheduled for hearings Tuesday.

United States Attorney Irving H. Saypol branded all four "contemptuous" in failing to reveal bail fund data before his Federal grand jury.

Probing Disappearances

The grand jury is looking into the disappearance of four top leaders of the Communist Party in the United States. They are Robert Thompson, Gilbert Green, Gus Hall and Henry Winston, all of whom failed to show up early this month to begin prison sentences for conspiring to teach and advocate violent revolution.

The Civil Rights Congress was ordered to forfeit \$80,000 in bail it posted for the four. In addition, it was outlawed as a future source of Federal bail for Communists.

Meanwhile, two more second-string Communist leaders put up \$20,000 bail each and were freed to await trial on the same revolutionary conspiracy charge that tripped the top Reds. The two were Claudia Jones and Betty Gannett.

That left seven second-stringers still jailed, unable to post bonds to replace the outlawed Civil Rights Congress bonds. Ten now are free on bond and four others—never arrested—are being sought.

Names Refused

The Government said the search for the four convicted fugitives might be aided by a list of persons who contributed to their bail through the Congress.

Three bond fund trustees went to prison for contempt when they refused to give this data. Leftist Millionaire Frederick Vanderbilt Field got 90 days and Mystery Writer Dashiell Hammett and W. Alphaeus Hunton six months each.

Field and Green were grand jury witnesses, along with Muriel Patterson, bookkeeper for the fund, and Dorothy Faulkner, telephone operator at the bail fund's office.

Saypol said Field declined to answer grand jury questions. He called Miss Patterson and Miss Faulkner "offensive and outrageous" in their conduct before the grand jury.

Saypol also included the bail fund's attorney, Mrs. Mary Kaufman, in his heated denunciation. But Judge McGohey took no action in regard to her.

The Civil Rights Congress has been branded Communist and subversive by the U.S. Attorney General's office.